

# 64 Shortening infinitives

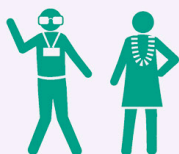
As well as ellipsis and substitution, you can also shorten (or “reduce”) infinitives to prevent repetition. This will help you to sound more natural when speaking.

-  **New language** Reduced infinitives
- Aa Vocabulary** Music and performance
-  **New skill** Avoiding repetition

## 64.1 KEY LANGUAGE REDUCED INFINITIVES

You can use “to” on its own rather than repeat the entire infinitive verb. You can only do this if the meaning remains clear.

**Let's go to see that new DJ tonight.**



I don't really want **to** [go to see the new DJ].

If the previous sentence or clause contains the verb “be,” then you must use to “be” in the next clause or sentence.

She **was** really critical of the new album.



It's difficult not **to be** [critical of it].  
The singing is awful!



## 64.2 CROSS OUT ALL OF THE WORDS THAT YOU CAN LEAVE OUT

I want to get the best tickets for the show, but can't afford to ~~get them~~.

- 1 I tried to contact Max about the concert tickets, but wasn't able to contact him.
- 2 My brother often forgets our dad's birthday, but this year he's promised not to forget.
- 3 Georgia was enjoying the performance. At least, she seemed to be enjoying it.
- 4 Ian is going to the new nightclub, but I don't really want to go to there.
- 5 The festival tickets cost a lot more than they used to cost.
- 6 I want to come with you, but I won't be able to come with you.

